

Skills That Matter

What’s left when the typing is free.

An angle is one thing the tool can’t hand you. It isn’t the only one, and the full list is shorter than the hype makes it sound.

AI can produce a first draft of almost anything in seconds. That changes what makes a person valuable. Producing the first version used to be most of the job. Now it’s the cheapest part of it. The bottleneck moves from production to direction.

You’ve been building most of these moves all course. A couple haven’t come up yet. What’s left is knowing which one to bring in at which moment.

REAL PROBLEMS DON’T ARRIVE AS PROMPTS

A prompt is a clean question. Almost nothing that actually lands on you is clean.

One messy problem, cut into three

WHAT LANDS ON YOU

Club attendance is down. Two officers think it’s the meeting time, one thinks nobody outside the group chat knows the club exists, and there’s one meeting left before break.

WHAT AI CAN ACTUALLY TAKE (once you’ve cut it up)

“Draft a five-question survey that tells us which of those three it is.”

“Give me ten meeting formats that work with fifteen people and no budget.”

“Turn our best three into a poster and a group-chat message.”

WHAT NEVER GOES IN THE BOX

Deciding this is a why-won’t-they-come problem and not a what-do-we-do-when-they-get-there problem. And picking one format out of ten, knowing which one this group will actually show up for.

Notice the two places you did the work. You cut a tangled situation into pieces small enough to hand over, which is the part AI won’t do for you, because it can’t see the tangle. Then you picked. AI can hand you ten options in four seconds. It has no idea which one fits your people.

Those two run inside one job. Four more run across all of them, and they’re worth knowing by name. Naming the move that’s missing is how you fix a bad answer, instead of just sitting there feeling like something’s off.

FOUR MOVES AI CAN’T OWN FOR YOU



Frame the real problem

AI is much more useful when the human knows what needs to be solved, who it is for, and what a good answer would look like.



Make sense of weird behavior

When you know that AI works through patterns, probability, context, and prediction, its weird behavior starts to make sense.



Check what matters

AI can sound confident when it is wrong. The better it sounds, the more important it becomes to know what needs verification.



Make the human call

AI can generate options. It cannot own your judgment, your values, your reputation, or the consequences of what you choose.

WHAT YOU'RE GOOD AT HAS A SHELF LIFE

Here’s the part nobody says out loud. Some of what you get good at is going to stop mattering, and not because you did anything wrong. A specific tool, a specific workflow, the exact trick that made you fast: all of it has a shelf life now, and the shelf lives keep getting shorter. Right now you have almost nothing to unlearn. That’s a real advantage, and it’s temporary. Give it a few years and you’ll be the one holding a method that used to work.

So the skill isn’t the method. It’s what you do the week the method stops working. It looks like three habits: you try things before you know they’ll work, you drop what you were good at when something better shows up, and you sit in not-knowing long enough to learn the new thing instead of retreating to the old one. That last one is the hard part. Being a beginner again, on purpose, is uncomfortable, and most people quit right there.

CAN WE, AND SHOULD WE

One more, and it’s the one people skip. AI turned “can we build this” into a question with almost no friction. Scrape every public post from your class and rank them. Build a bot that texts in your voice. Automate a job three people currently do. The building isn’t the hard part anymore.

Which moves the whole question. “Can we” is answered. “Should we” isn’t, and no model is going to raise its hand and ask it for you. It will hand you the plan. Someone in the room has to be the person who asks who this lands on, who never got a say, and what happens if it works exactly the way it’s designed to.

That isn’t a rule you look up. It’s a judgment you make, and you’ll be making it earlier in your life than anyone before you had to.

AI MAKES PRODUCTION CHEAP.

That’s what makes the rest of it expensive. None of what’s on this page replaces AI. It’s what makes AI worth using, and it’s the part that stays yours no matter what ships next.

The typing got cheap.

The judgment didn’t.